SUMACADE

makes about 1 quart

Many edible varieties of sumac grow all over Turtle Island and are related to the variety often found in Eastern Mediterranean and Middle Eastern food. When infused, the berries produce a tart lemonade-like drink that can look like tea or have a blush pink color.

- 2 clusters fresh sumac berries or ¼ cup ground dried sumac
- 3 to 4 tablespoons agave syrup or honey
- Ice, for serving

If using fresh sumac berries: Pull apart the berry clusters and discard any large stem pieces. Place in a bowl, cover with fresh water, and agitate them so that any debris falls away. Lift the berries into a colander and rinse some more, then let drain.

Transfer the berries to a large measuring cup or pitcher and use a large spoon to mash them up for 1 minute. Add 4 cups water and let stand for 4 to 8 hours. (The longer it steeps, the stronger it will be.)

Strain the infusion through a fine-mesh sieve or cheesecloth into another pitcher, then stir in 3 tablespoons agave syrup. Taste and add the remaining tablespoon, as needed. Serve over ice.

If using ground dried sumac: In a saucepan, bring 4 cups water to a boil over high heat. Remove from the heat, stir in the ground sumac, and let it steep for about 20 minutes.

Proceed with the same straining, sweetening, and serving instructions here.

Cover and refrigerate the sumacade for up to 2 days.